# Lucas Salamanca Fernández

Pre-Doctoral Research Fellow
Department of Economics and Business
Universitat Pompeu Fabra, Barcelona, Spain

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Citizenship: Peru

## Research Interests

**Fields:** International Trade, Macroeconomics, Economic Growth and Development
**Topics:** Public procurement, trade frictions, firm heterogeneity and misallocation

## Education

**Barcelona School of Economics (BSE)** — Barcelona, Spain
*M.Sc. in Specialized Economic Analysis: International Trade, Finance and Development* — *2025 – 2026*

- GPA: 9.0/10. BSE Merit Scholarship recipient.
- Thesis: *Revisiting Economic Growth: Frictions, Complexity and Productivity* (best thesis of the cohort). Advisors: Fernando Broner and Manuel García-Santana.

**Pontificia Universidad Católica del Perú (PUCP)** — Lima, Peru
*B.A. in Economics* — *2020 – 2024*

- GPA: 16.8/20. Ranked **1st** in the graduating class of 2024.

**University of Helsinki** — Helsinki, Finland
*Exchange semester, Economics* — *Spring 2023*

- GPA: 4.5/5.

## Honors, Awards & Scholarships

**Best Master's Thesis of the Cohort**, BSE M.Sc. in International Trade, Finance and Development 2026
**BSE Merit Scholarship**, awarded to only 8% of applicants on academic merit 2025
**First in Class Award**, Dept. of Economics, PUCP (USD 300 prize) 2024

## Research

**Revisiting Economic Growth: Frictions, Complexity and Productivity** (2026)
with Ahmed Ahmed, Jakob Bela Büchner, Harrison Read and Tommaso Trabona.
*BSE Master's Thesis, best thesis of the cohort; published in UPF e-Repositori:* hdl.handle.net/10230/148650

We study whether economic complexity helps explain cross-country productivity differences and why complex production emerges unevenly across countries. Development accounting and panel regressions show that the Economic Complexity Index is robustly associated with higher TFP levels and predicts subsequent TFP growth. We microfound this link in a multi-industry Melitz framework in which fixed production and export costs are log-supermodular in product complexity and country-level frictions, and show with manufacturing-export data that institutional and logistical frictions disproportionately reduce export activation and export values of complex products.

## Research Experience

**Universitat Pompeu Fabra** — Barcelona, Spain
*Pre-Doctoral Research Fellow to Prof. Manuel García-Santana (ERC project)* — *Sep 2026 – Present*

- Study the firm-level and aggregate effects of public procurement.
- Build firm-level datasets linking procurement and firm records; estimate procurement home bias with gravity models; support calibration and counterfactual analysis in quantitative trade and general-equilibrium models.

**sistemaFutura** Remote
*Research Analyst* *Oct 2024 – Sep 2025*

- Collected, cleaned and merged micro and macro datasets in Python for several agent-based models; estimated econometric models of life-event transition probabilities.

**Group for the Analysis of Development (GRADE)** Lima, Peru
*Research Assistant* *Apr 2024 – Jun 2024*

- Developed methodologies to quantify the social costs of informal self-construction in Peru (risk, health and environmental costs), combining economic and public-health data in Stata.

**APOYO Consultoría** Lima, Peru
*Macroeconomic Analysis Intern* *Aug 2023 – Dec 2023*

- Developed econometric models for national GDP projections; supported client reports and presentations.

## Teaching Experience

**Universitat de Barcelona** Barcelona, Spain
*Lecturer, Macroeconomics I — B.A. in Business Administration* *Spring 2027*

## Editorial Experience

***Economía* (journal of the Department of Economics, PUCP)** Remote
*Assistant Editor* *Feb 2024 – Present*

- Conduct the initial screening of submissions; coordinate the peer-review process between associate editors, referees and authors, and the editing of accepted articles for publication.

## Skills & Languages

**Programming:** Python, Stata, R, MATLAB, QGIS; Git/GitHub; LaTeX; EViews.
**Languages:** Spanish (native), English (C2, IELTS), French (B1), Finnish (B1).

## References

**Manuel García-Santana**
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